

MAGNETO

Master of magnetism

MAGNETO

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Unrevealed, uses the name Erik Magnus Lehnsherr

OCCUPATION

Conqueror

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT

6 ft 2 in

WEIGHT

190 lbs

EYES

Blue-grey

HAIR

White

FIRST APPEARANCE

X-Men #1,
(September 1963)

POWERS

Mutant ability to manipulate magnetism and all forms of electromagnetic energy

ALLIES/FOES

ALLIES Brotherhood of Evil Mutants, (sometimes) Professor Charles Xavier, (formerly) the X-Men, the New Mutants

FOES Professor Charles Xavier, the X-Men, the Avengers, the Fantastic Four

ISSUE #1

In the first X-Men comic, Magneto captured the Cape Citadel missile base, only to be defeated by the original X-Men in their initial battle.



Magneto's sufferings in his youth inspired his hatred of humankind.

One of the most powerful and dangerous of all mutants, Magneto has been both the foremost enemy of the X-Men and, sometimes, their ally. As a boy, he was imprisoned in the Nazi death camp in Auschwitz, Poland. Sickness and malnourishment prevented Magneto's mutant powers from emerging there. In Auschwitz, Magneto's family perished, and he witnessed the inhumanity that people can show to those who are considered different.

MUTANT RAGE

Following World War II Magneto married Magda, and they had a daughter, Anya. When Anya was trapped in a burning building, an insensitive crowd prevented Magneto from rescuing her. Infuriated, Magneto lashed out with his powers, killing them.

Frightened by what her husband had done, Magda fled from him. She had not told Magneto that she was pregnant. Eventually Magda arrived at Wundagore Mountain, where she gave birth to twins, Wanda and Pietro. She then ran away into the wilderness, where she presumably died.

While searching for Magda, Magneto employed a forger named George Odekirk to create a false identity, "Erik Magnus Lehnsherr," for him. Eventually Magneto settled in Israel, where he became friends with the young Charles Xavier (see PROFESSOR X). They continually debated their different views on whether mutants could peacefully coexist with the rest of humanity.

SUPERIORITY COMPLEX

When their friend Gabrielle Haller was abducted by Baron von Strucker and his HYDRA agents, Magneto and Xavier rescued her. Magneto used his powers to make off with a cache of Nazi gold that Strucker had sought. Magneto decided that the only way to prevent humanity from oppressing the emerging race of mutants was for mutants to conquer the rest of the human race. Indeed, Magneto believed that mutants were superior to ordinary humans and deserved to rule them.

Magneto's first step in his war against the human race was to seize a missile base at Cape Citadel, Florida. By now Xavier had founded the X-Men, who foiled Magneto's takeover of the base.



Magneto magnetically shielded Magda and Anya in a burning inn, but could not save Anya's life.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• **X-Men Vol. 1 #4-7, 11**

Magneto's original Brotherhood of Evil Mutants battles the original team of X-Men.

• **X-Men Vol. 1 #62-63**

Magneto's unmasked face is revealed when he confronts the X-Men in the Savage Land.

• **Uncanny X-Men #161**

The story of how Magneto first met Charles Xavier in Israel.

• **Classic X-Men #12**

Magneto's captivity at Auschwitz and the death of his daughter.



A resistance movement including Cyclops, Spider-Man, and Wolverine attacked Magneto's House of M before the Scarlet Witch finally restored reality to its previous normalcy.

When Magneto next battled the X-Men, it was as leader of the original BROTHERHOOD OF EVIL MUTANTS. The other members were Mastermind, the Toad, and Pietro and Wanda (QUICKSILVER and the SCARLET WITCH), who felt obligated to Magneto for saving them from a mob. Neither Magneto nor Wanda and Pietro realized that Magneto was their father.

After numerous clashes with the X-Men, Magneto tried to force a superhuman being known as the STRANGER to serve him. He little knew that the Stranger was actually an alien with seemingly limitless powers who captured Magneto and the Toad.

Weary of Magneto's crusade against humanity, Quicksilver and the Scarlet Witch quit the Brotherhood and soon joined the AVENGERS.

Magneto eventually escaped back to Earth from the Stranger's planet and resumed his war on humanity, battling the X-Men, Avengers, FANTASTIC FOUR, and DEFENDERS. He also formed several new versions of the Brotherhood.



THE HOUSE OF M

1 Quicksilver 2 Scarlet Witch
3 Scarlet Witch's sons Thomas and William
4 Magneto 5 Polaris

THE HOUSE OF MAGNUS

Urged by her brother Quicksilver, the Scarlet Witch utilized her mutant power over probability to alter history. As a result, Magneto had led mutants in a successful war against the rest of humanity. Magneto was now monarch of Earth. His royal family was known as the "House of Magnus" or "House of M" and was comprised of his son Quicksilver, his daughters the Scarlet Witch and Polaris, and his grandsons Thomas and William.

physically considerably younger today than his contemporaries from the World War II period.

Magneto resumed his battles against the X-Men, but eventually MacTaggart's tampering with his mind took effect, and he became the X-Men's ally. During an extended absence from Earth by Xavier, Magneto even took over as headmaster of Xavier's school, mentoring the NEW MUTANTS. Around this time, Magneto, Quicksilver and the Scarlet Witch learned their true relationship.

THE TRUCE IS OVER

In time Magneto's previous personality re-emerged. After he created an electromagnetic pulse that deactivated technology all over the world, the United Nations gave him control of the island of Genosha, which was mainly populated by mutants. However, the island was devastated by SENTINELS sent by Cassandra Nova.

During a fit of madness, the Scarlet Witch used her powers to alter reality so that Magneto ruled the world (House of M story arc). She later restored the status quo, and also deprived most mutants of their powers, including Magneto. The Collective (see GUARDIAN), being controlled by Magneto-impersonator Xorn, briefly returned his powers to him. Recently, the HIGH EVOLUTIONARY repowered him.

TB, MF



An alternate reality Magneto and his Brotherhood attempted to destroy Earth.
1 Wolverine 2 Rogue 3 Ice-Man 4 Mystique 5 Magneto